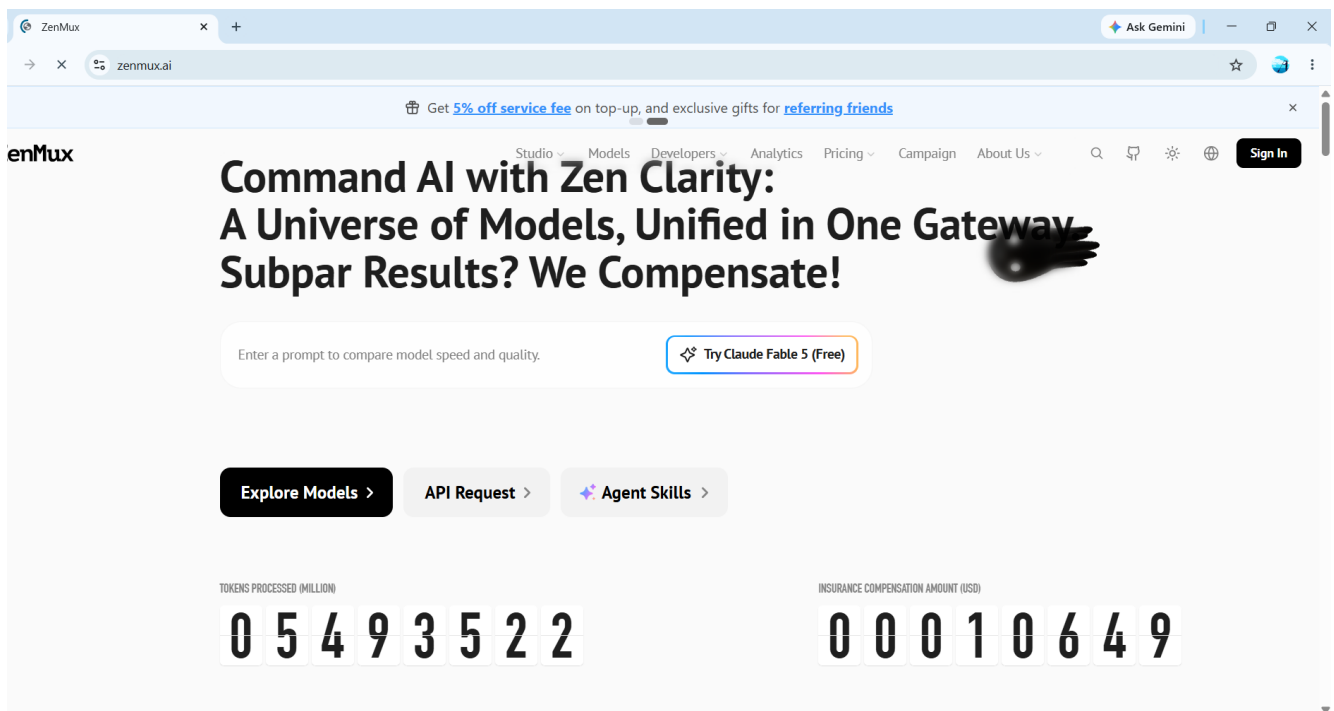


ZenMux Claude Fable 5 Setup Guide

Using ZenMux for model access and configuring the ZenMux API key in Claude Code on Windows



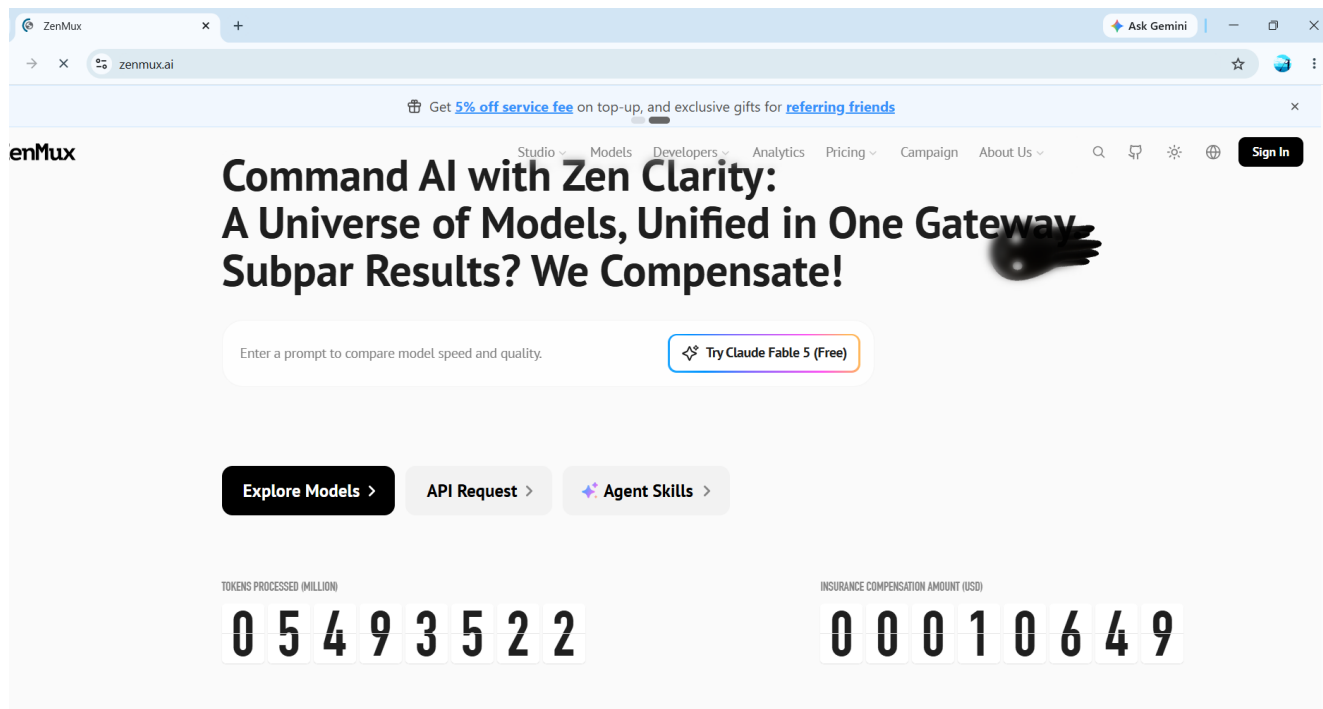
What this guide covers

1. Open ZenMux and sign in. 2. Locate Claude Fable 5 (Free). 3. Create/copy a ZenMux API key. 4. Configure Claude Code through the user-level system settings file. 5. Verify the connection and troubleshoot common environment-variable conflicts.

Important: Never share your real API key in screenshots, chat messages, source control, or documentation. The examples below use placeholders.

1. Open ZenMux and select Claude Fable 5

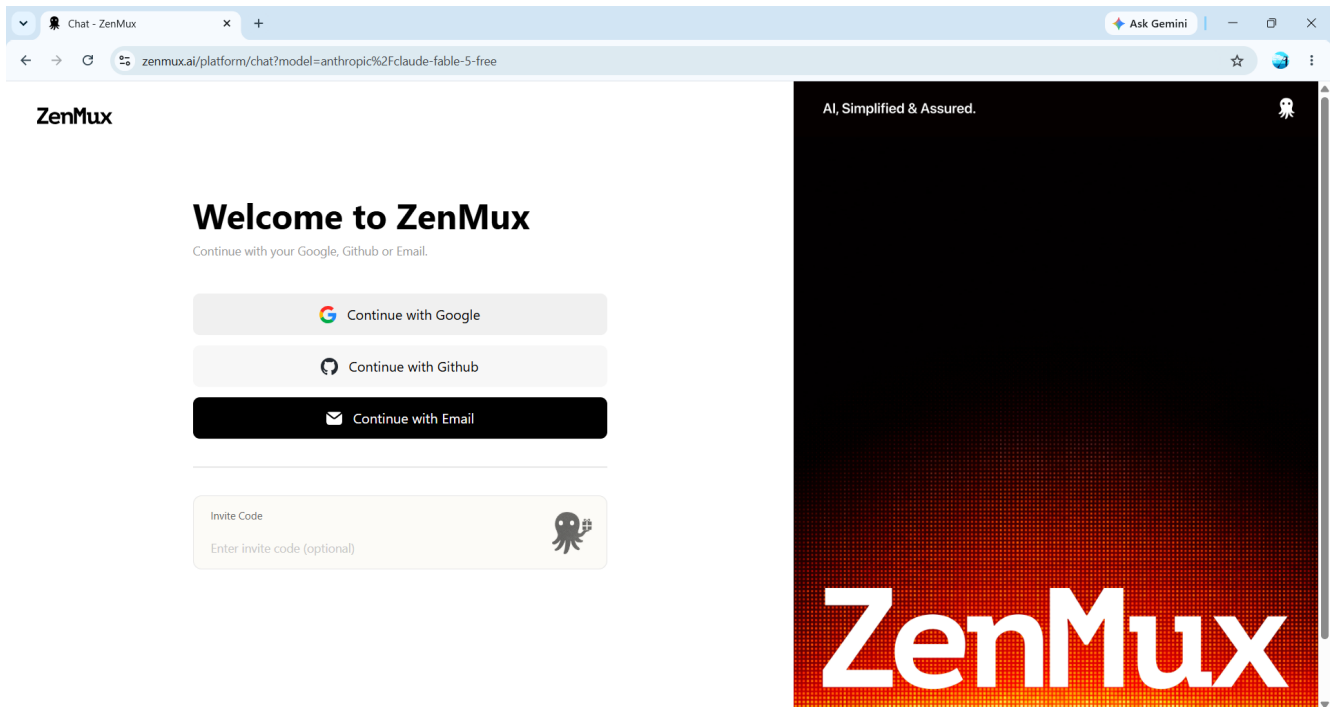
Step 1: Open ZenMux in your browser. From the home page, select **Try Claude Fable 5 (Free)** or open the Models area and search for the model.



The supplied screenshot shows the ZenMux home page and the shortcut for trying Claude Fable 5 (Free).

2. Sign in to ZenMux

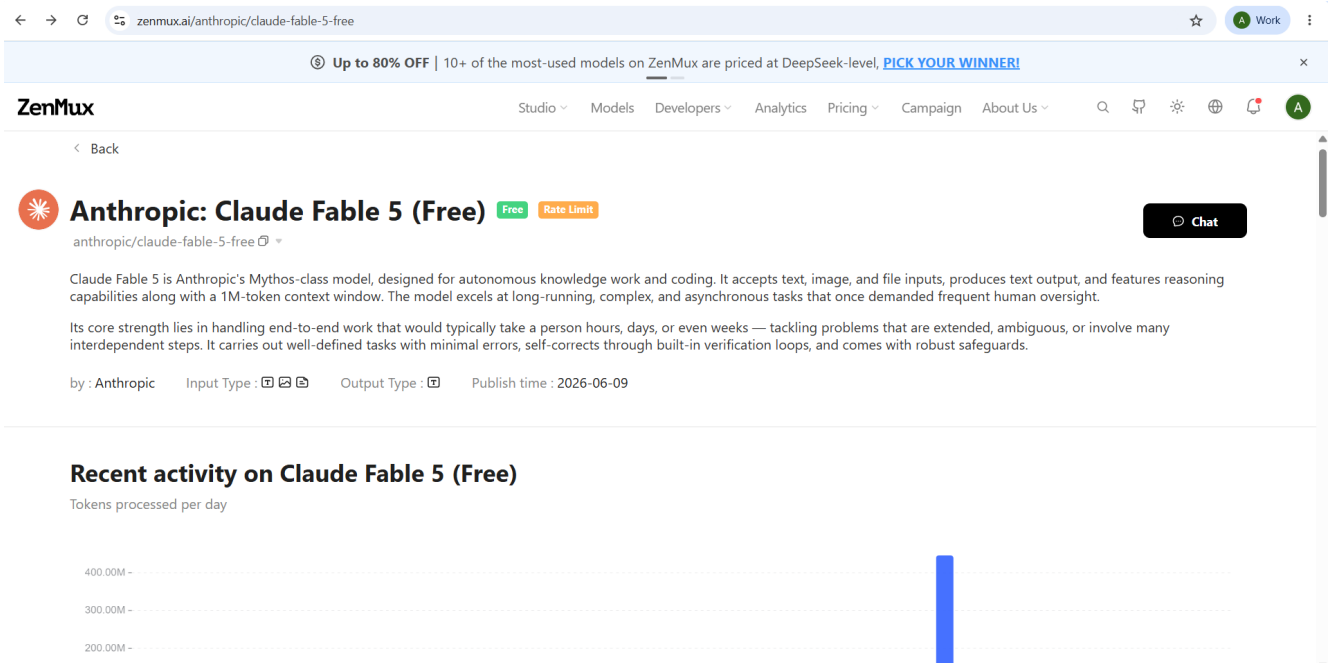
Step 2: Sign in with Google, GitHub, or Email. The invite-code field is shown as optional in the supplied sign-in screenshot.



After authentication, return to the model page if ZenMux does not redirect you there automatically.

3. Confirm the model page and model ID

Step 3: Open the Claude Fable 5 (Free) model page. Confirm the model name and copy the model identifier displayed below the title.



The screenshot shows the ZenMux website interface. The browser address bar displays 'zenmux.ai/anthropic/claude-fable-5-free'. The ZenMux header includes navigation links: Studio, Models, Developers, Analytics, Pricing, Campaign, and About Us. The main content area features the model title 'Anthropic: Claude Fable 5 (Free)' with 'Free' and 'Rate Limit' badges. Below the title is the identifier 'anthropic/claude-fable-5-free' and a 'Chat' button. A description of the model follows, stating it is designed for autonomous knowledge work and coding. At the bottom, a section titled 'Recent activity on Claude Fable 5 (Free)' shows a bar chart of tokens processed per day, with a single blue bar reaching approximately 400,000 tokens.

In the supplied screenshot, the displayed model identifier is:

anthropic/claude-fable-5-free

The page also marks the model as **Free** and **Rate Limit**. Availability, rate limits, and model naming can change, so use the exact identifier shown in your current ZenMux account.

4. Create or copy your ZenMux API key

Step 4: In ZenMux, open the developer/API-key area from the Developers menu or account dashboard. Create a new API key, give it a recognizable name such as **Claude-Code-Windows**, and copy it immediately to a secure password manager or secret store.

ZenMux documentation examples show API keys in forms such as **sk-ss-v1-...** or **sk-ai-v1-....** Use your own generated key; do not copy a sample key from documentation.

ZenMux Anthropic-compatible base URL

```
https://zenmux.ai/api/anthropic
```

For Anthropic Messages API requests, ZenMux documents the messages endpoint under this base URL. Claude Code should be pointed at the Anthropic-compatible base URL rather than the OpenAI-compatible /api/v1 endpoint.

Security tip: If a real API key was ever pasted into a public issue, repository, screenshot, or shared document, revoke it and create a new one.

5. Add the ZenMux API key to Claude Code system/user settings

For a Windows user-level Claude Code configuration, create or edit the following file:

```
%USERPROFILE%\.claude\settings.json
```

Example: if your Windows user name is **Alex**, the resolved path is **C:\Users\Alex\.claude\settings.json**. The **%USERPROFILE%** form is safer because it works for the currently signed-in Windows user.

Recommended settings.json configuration

```
{
  "env": {
    "ANTHROPIC_BASE_URL": "https://zenmux.ai/api/anthropic",
    "ANTHROPIC_AUTH_TOKEN": "YOUR_ZENMUX_API_KEY",
    "ANTHROPIC_MODEL": "anthropic/claude-fable-5-free"
  }
}
```

Replace **YOUR_ZENMUX_API_KEY** with your real ZenMux key. Keep the JSON syntax valid: double quotes, commas between entries, and no trailing comma after the last property.

Why these variables?

ANTHROPIC_BASE_URL routes Claude Code requests to ZenMux. **ANTHROPIC_AUTH_TOKEN** supplies the ZenMux credential to the gateway. **ANTHROPIC_MODEL** selects the model ID shown on the ZenMux model page.

6. Windows step-by-step: create the settings file

Option A — File Explorer + Notepad

1. Press **Win + R**, type `%USERPROFILE%`, and press Enter.
2. Open the `.claude` folder. If it does not exist, create it.
3. Create or edit `settings.json`.
4. Paste the JSON configuration from the previous page.
5. Replace the placeholder API key and save the file.
6. Close all running Claude Code terminals, open a new terminal, and run `claude`.

Option B — PowerShell

```
New-Item -ItemType Directory -Force "$env:USERPROFILE\.claude"  
notepad "$env:USERPROFILE\.claude\settings.json"  
claude
```

The first command ensures the configuration directory exists, the second opens the user settings file, and the third starts Claude Code after you save the configuration.

Note: Do not put the API key directly into a project repository. A user-level settings file is convenient for a single workstation, but it still contains a secret in plain text. Protect your Windows account and do not sync or commit this file.

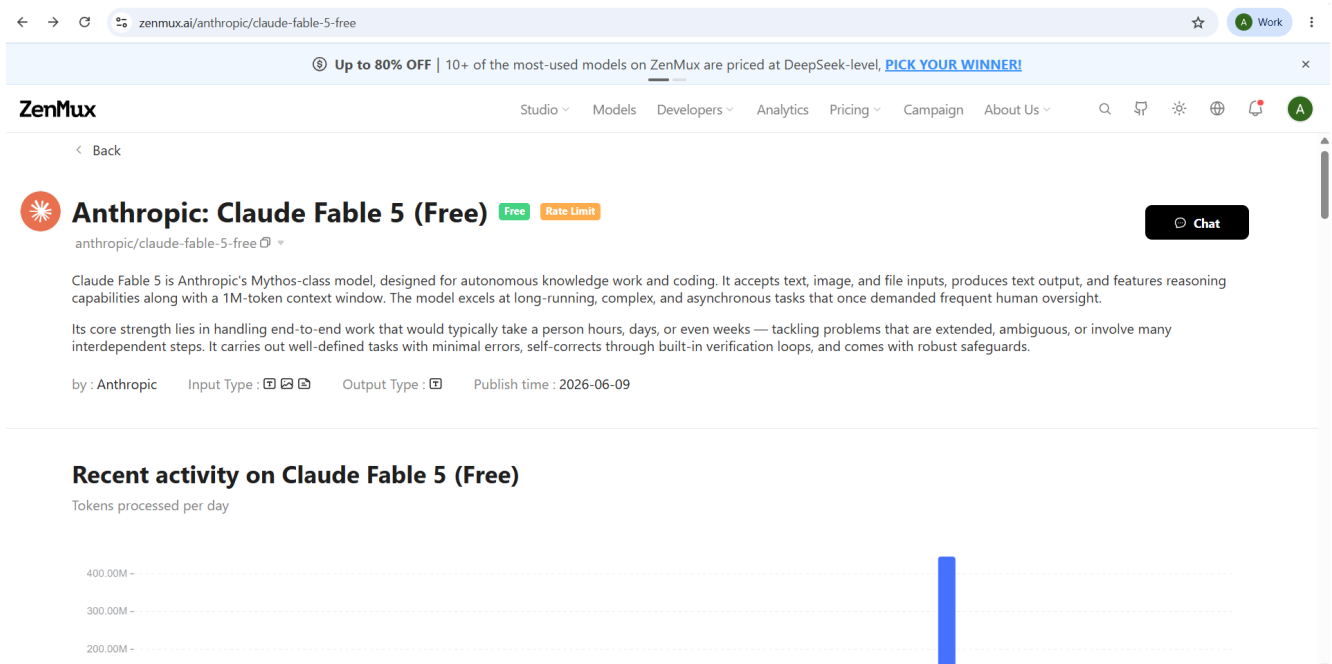
7. Verify that Claude Code is using ZenMux

Start a new terminal session and run:

```
c laude
```

Then send a small test prompt, for example: **Reply with: ZenMux connection successful.** If the request succeeds, the gateway, authentication token, and model routing are working.

You can also review ZenMux usage/activity in the dashboard. The supplied model screenshot includes a recent-activity section showing tokens processed per day.



8. Troubleshooting

Claude Code still uses another provider or key

Check whether `ANTHROPIC_API_KEY`, `ANTHROPIC_AUTH_TOKEN`, or `ANTHROPIC_BASE_URL` is already set in Windows environment variables, PowerShell profile scripts, CMD sessions, or another Claude Code configuration scope. Conflicting values can cause authentication or routing problems. Restart the terminal after changes.

401 / authentication error

Confirm that the ZenMux key is active, complete, and pasted without spaces or quotation marks inside the value. If the key may have been exposed, revoke it and generate a replacement.

Model not found / invalid model

Re-open the ZenMux model page and copy the current model identifier exactly. Free models can be rate-limited or changed by the provider, so the identifier shown in your current dashboard is the source of truth.

Wrong endpoint

For Claude Code, use ZenMux's Anthropic-compatible base URL: **`https://zenmux.ai/api/anthropic`**. Do not use the OpenAI-compatible **`/api/v1`** base URL for this Claude Code configuration.

JSON error

Validate that `settings.json` contains one valid JSON object. Typical mistakes are missing commas, smart quotes copied from formatted documents, duplicate top-level objects, or a trailing comma.

9. Quick configuration checklist

- ZenMux account created and signed in.
- Claude Fable 5 (Free) model page opened.
- Current model ID copied from ZenMux.
- ZenMux API key generated and stored securely.
- **%USERPROFILE%\claude\settings.json** created or edited.
- **ANTHROPIC_BASE_URL** set to ZenMux Anthropic endpoint.
- **ANTHROPIC_AUTH_TOKEN** set to the ZenMux API key.
- **ANTHROPIC_MODEL** set to the ZenMux model ID.
- Terminal restarted and **claude** tested with a small prompt.
- ZenMux activity dashboard checked for successful usage.

Reference notes

This guide was prepared from the screenshots supplied by the user and cross-checked against the current ZenMux documentation for its Anthropic-compatible endpoint and the Claude Code documentation for settings files and environment-variable configuration.